



Airplane

Airplanes are heavier than air, so they need to overcome the force of gravity, which pulls them toward the ground. They do this with the help of curved wings, which produce an upward force, called lift, as the plane moves through the air. Most aircraft today are monoplanes, which means they have a single set of wings. This **de Havilland DH60 Gipsy Moth** is a biplane, with two pairs of wings and an open cockpit with two seats.

Tail › Most aircraft have a tail consisting of a fixed fin, horizontal tailplanes, and hinged rudder and elevator flaps. The rudder is moved by controls in the cockpit to help the aircraft turn. Elevators control up and down movements.



Fuselage › This is the body of the aircraft to which wings are attached, and where the pilot and passengers sit. The Gipsy Moth's fuselage is made of a wooden frame covered in fabric. Most plane fuselages today are made of metals or materials, such as carbon fiber.